

Kangaroo

Red kangaroos are the largest marsupials—mammals that carry their young in a pouch. They can be up to 6 ft (1.8 m) in height. Kangaroos use their strong legs and powerful tails to hop across the scrublands and deserts of Australia.

Females are usually smaller and grayer than the males.

Powerful male

The winning male may have fought off up to 10 competitors to win his chosen mate. He then checks if the female is ready for mating by smelling her urine (pee).

Carrying joey

After mating, the female is pregnant for only a month. The newborn joey is just 1 inch (2.5 cm) long—about the size of a lima bean. Shortly after birth, the joey climbs up into its mother's pouch.

The pouch protects the joey as it nurses and grows.

See also

Read about the sea horse (92–93), who also has a pouch—but it's the dad that carries the offspring, as eggs.

Suckling

The mother's pouch is lined with mammary glands that produce milk to feed her young. The joey finds a nipple and latches onto it—it can stay attached for up to 70 days.

